

Botan Buran

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Substantive: Alignments, regional security, regional balancing, Middle Eastern politics, interstate conflicts, alliance reliability, military coups' effects on democracy.

Methodological: Applied statistics, mixed-methodological approach, process tracing, case study.

TEACHING INTERESTS

Substantive: International security, Middle Eastern politics, International relations theory, qualitative methods.

Methodological: Research design, quantitative methods, qualitative methods, mixed-methodological methods.

EDUCATION

- **Georgia State University** 2022 - Expected 2027
Ph.D. Candidate, Political Science Atlanta, GA, USA
 - Subfields: International Relations (major), Political Methodology (minor)
 - Dissertation: The Myth of Regional Balance of Power
 - Advisor: Dan Altman
- **TOBB University of Economics and Technology** 2019 - August 2021
M.A., International Relations Ankara, Turkey
 - Thesis: Threat And Underbalancing: A Neoclassical Realist Analysis of Turkey's Iran Policy During the Ahmadinejad Period (2005-2013)
 - Advisor: Saban Kardas
- **Università degli Studi di Firenze** 2014 - 2015
Exchange Student Florence, Italy
 - International Relations program
- **Sakarya University** 2012 - January 2018
B.A., International Relations Sakarya, Turkey
 - Graduated with a degree in International Relations

WORKING PAPERS

- **The Myth of Regional Balance of Power** 2023 - Present
Article from Dissertation [\[In progress\]](#)
- **The Myth of Regional Hegemony** 2023 - Present
Article from Dissertation [\[In progress\]](#)
- **Revisiting the Saudi reaction to the "Iranian threat": A case of overbalancing?** 2025
Co-author: Saban Kardas [Article Manuscript](#)
- **Threat and Underbalancing: Analysis of Turkey's Iran policy during the Ahmadinejad Era** 2025
Co-author: Saban Kardas [Article Manuscript](#)
- **Good authoritarian and bad authoritarian: Are personalist regimes reliable allies?** 2024- Present
[\[In progress\]](#)
- **Strategic environment and cross-border incursions: The case of Turkey** 2024- Present
[\[In progress\]](#)
- **Differentiating the military interventions: Effects on democracy in Turkey** 2024- Present
Co-author: Efe Can Coban [\[In progress\]](#)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- **The Myth of Regional Balance of Power** *September 2026*
APSA [\[In-person\]](#)
- **The Myth of Regional Balance of Power** *March 2026*
ISA [\[In-person\]](#)
- **The Myth of Regional Balance of Power** *October 2025*
IS-SSS [\[In-person\]](#)
- **Revisiting the Saudi reaction to the "Iranian threat": A case of overbalancing?** *March 2024*
Gulf Studies Symposium, Georgetown University [\[In-person\]](#)
 - Co-authored with Saban Kardas
- **The Myth of Regional Balance of Power** *October 2023*
ISA South [\[In-person\]](#)
- **The Myth of Regional Balance of Power** *March 2023*
Atlanta Symposium on Political Science (ASOPS) [\[In-person\]](#)
- **Threat and Underbalancing: Analysis of Turkey's Iran policy during the Ahmadinejad Era** *December 2022*
IS-SSS [\[In-person\]](#)
 - Co-authored with Saban Kardas

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- **Georgia State University** *Fall 2026*
Instructor, POLS 1101: Introduction to American Government *Atlanta, GA, USA*
- **Georgia State University** *Fall 2026*
Teaching Assistant for POLS 1101: Introduction to American Government Simulcast Class *Atlanta, GA, USA*
- **Georgia State University** *Summer 2026*
Instructor, POLS 1101: Introduction to American Government *Atlanta, GA, USA*
- **Georgia State University** *Spring 2024*
Instructor, POLS 2401: Global Studies *Atlanta, GA, USA*
- **Georgia State University** *Fall 2023*
Research Assistant for Dr. Kim Reimann *Atlanta, GA, USA*
- **Georgia State University** *Spring 2023*
Teaching Assistant, GLOS 3000 / INDS 3000: Interdisciplinary Approaches to Research *Atlanta, GA, USA*
- **Georgia State University** *Spring 2023*
Teaching Assistant, POLS 3450: U.S. Foreign Policy *Atlanta, GA, USA*
- **Georgia State University** *Fall 2022*
Teaching Assistant, POLS 1101: Introduction to American Government *Atlanta, GA, USA*

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- **Georgia State University, Political Science Department** *September 2024 - Present*
Manager of the Department's Website and Social Media Accounts *Atlanta, GA, USA*
 - Manage the department's online presence and digital communications
- **Graduate Student Association, Georgia State University** *August 2025 - Present*
President *Atlanta, GA, USA*
 - Lead graduate student organization, represent student interests
- **Graduate Student Association, Georgia State University** *August 2023 - August 2024*
Professional Development Chair *Atlanta, GA, USA*
 - Organized professional development events for graduate students

- Coordinated workshops and networking opportunities

- **Gulf Data Project, Qatar University**

Project Management Assistant

September 2021 - November 2021

Ankara, Turkey (Remote)

- Collected Large-N data on foreign aid of Qatar and UAE
- Assisted with project coordination and data management

GRANTS AND FELLOWSHIPS

- Georgia State University, Department of Political Science Travel Grant *Fall 2025*
APSA [\$250]
- APSA Travel Grant *Fall 2026*
[\$400]
- ISA Travel Grant *Spring 2026*
[\$600]
- Georgia State University, Department of Political Science Travel Grant *Fall 2025*
IS-SSS [\$250]
- Georgia State University, Department of Political Science Travel Grant *Spring 2024*
Gulf Studies Symposium, Georgetown University [\$250]
- **GSU Political Science Department's Summer Research & Professional Development Fellowship** 2024
For ICPSR Summer School [\$2600]
- Awarded to support methodological training at ICPSR Summer Program

METHODOLOGICAL TRAINING

- **ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods** 2024
Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research
- (2024) Bayesian Modeling for the Social Sciences I: Introduction and Application (EITM Certification, received A+)
- (2024) Introduction to Time Series and Panel Data Analysis (EITM Certification, received A)
- (2024) Causal Inference for the Social Sciences (audited)

SKILLS

- **Statistical Software:** R
- **Text Analysis Software:** NVivo
- **Typesetting:** LaTeX
- **Video Solutions for Online Course Development:** Loom, Kaltura
- **Productivity Software:** MS Office
- **Languages:** Turkish (native), English (fluent), Italian (beginner), Kurdish (beginner)

REFERENCES

1. **Dan Altman**
Associate Professor of Political Science
Georgia State University
Email: daltman@gsu.edu
Relationship: Dissertation Advisor

2. **Louis-Alexander Berg**
Associate Professor of Political Science
Georgia State University
Email: lberg@gsu.edu
Relationship: Committee
3. **William "Bill" Long**
Professor of Political Science
Georgia State University
Email: long@gsu.edu
Relationship: Committee
4. **Jelena Subotić**
Professor of Political Science
Georgia State University
Email: jsubotic@gsu.edu
Relationship: Professor